WORKSHOP INTRO

4 × 4

Four themes · four lenses

16 short slides for the four topic pitches

Workshop objective **Turn priority questions into a clear mission, realistic targets, concrete outcomes and a lightweight roadmap to the end of 2028.**

01 Annalisa	02 Simon	03 Gregor	04 Martin
Strategy, Governance and Organisation	**People, Skills and Ways of Working**	**AI Applications and Value Creation**	**Data, Technologies and Infrastructure**

Each topic is presented through the same four questions

01 **Where are we**

02 **Trends**

03 **Proposed targets**

04 **Potential outcomes & actions**

One slide per question keeps the 5-minute topic pitches simple, visual and easy to facilitate.

TOPIC 1

Strategy, Governance and Organisation

Strategic and organisational foundation for the other three topics

01 Where are we

- Strategic and governance documents already exist in EU and outside, with a certain level of fragmentation
- Guiding principles: how much data and AI one's overlap? Is it correct to consider AI simply “software”?
- The advancements on strategy and governance maturity are diversified among member states
- On Organization: not all the countries have a dedicated office for Digitalization and AI

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How the environmental matter is considered across present regulations?

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Strategy, Governance and Organisation

Strategic and organisational foundation for the other three topics

02 Trends

- Technology goes faster than regulation
- Overabundance of tools – that we use hapazardly
- Once risks and challenges have been evaluated, regulations (Strategies and governance tools) are necessary
- People, ethics and the environment are the three pillars on which a fair strategy could be based

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We need to organize tools and competencies, we need the roots for this fast-growing tree

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Strategy, Governance and Organisation

Strategic and organisational foundation for the other three topics

03 Proposed targets to be achieved

- **On strategy:** Collecting the status and outlook of AI in environmental domain in Europe focusing on principles, ethics and environment
- **On governance:** Understand how and in which measure Eionet can contribute with regulatory instruments to the European AI Strategy
- **On organisation:** Filling gaps in Digital capabilities and AI application

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What two or three strategic changes should be visible by the end of 2028?

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Strategy, Governance and Organisation

Strategic and organisational foundation for the other three topics

04 Potential outcomes & actions

- Shared AI-for-environment vision document presenting the current landscape, emerging trends, common needs and outlook towards 2028
- Establishing an observatory on AI governance evolution for the environment
- European environmental monitoring network to monitor AI and large computational facilities

...just to mention some :-)

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Do we want to share documents? Best practices? Experience and know-how?

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TOPIC 2

People, Skills and Ways of Working

Build practical capability through peer learning, shared resources and new working practices

01 Where are we

- TG survey
  - top priorities: Basic AI literacy · Knowledge sharing and capacity building · New Roles & responsibilities
  - 45–55% needing support
- TG Workshop in June
  - Basic literacy scales — domain skills do not
  - The hard part: judging AI output, not using tools
- Submitted Use Cases: SmartLab (DE), Teams Helpdesk (EEA)

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What do members need — and what can they already offer?

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People, Skills and Ways of Working

Build practical capability through peer learning, shared resources and new working practices

02 Trends

- AI Act makes basic AI literacy a legal duty
- Central training capacity often cannot or do not meet demand
- New AI roles emerge — unplanned and unnamed
- Existing roles change faster than job profiles
- Fear of job loss is part of the conversation

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What has to change in how we work, not just in what we know?

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Where are we | Trends | Targets | Outcomes & actions

People, Skills and Ways of Working

Build practical capability through peer learning, shared resources and new working practices

03 Proposed targets to be achieved

- A shared picture of what the network needs, who can help, and which AI roles exist where
- A common AI literacy baseline every agency can point to
- A peer-learning series that: X sessions by 2028, each leaving reusable material

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Which skills do agencies need to use AI responsibly and confidently by 2028?

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People, Skills and Ways of Working

Build practical capability through peer learning, shared resources and new working practices

04 Potential outcomes & actions

- Capability Map — who needs what, who can help, which roles exist where
- AI Literacy Reference — what everyone should know, plus role-specific modules
- Peer-Learning Series — X sessions by 2028, hosted by members themselves

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Start small: what could we actually run with voluntary contributions?

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TOPIC 3

AI Applications and Value Creation

Prioritise concrete problems and expected value — not particular tools or technologies

01 Where are we

- AI needs a solid data foundation to produce reliable and meaningful results – even with established standards, member states still provide their data in different forms and quality
- various projects try to remedy this and build solutions for data harmonisation and mobilisation
- Common AI strategy is missing from EU down to MS and organisational level
- still strong dependency on (US or Chinese) vendors

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Which existing or proposed use cases are worth sharing?

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AI Applications and Value Creation

Prioritise concrete problems and expected value — not particular tools or technologies

02 Trends

- industry is moving from individual vibe coded solutions towards agentic open platforms using protocols that AI agents understand (Agent2Agent protocols and Enterprise security policy and integration)
- Local and open models gain traction and become more powerful, also vendor-supported (Gemini, Qwen,...) solutions
- Hardware (NVIDIA, Apple) is moving AI capabilities from the data center to the edge -> independence and privacy.

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How do we distinguish interesting demos from scalable value?

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AI Applications and Value Creation

Prioritise concrete problems and expected value — not particular tools or technologies

03 Proposed targets to be achieved

- identify limits and barriers to AI adoption in your current environment, considering:
  - AI policies (too restrictive or too broad?)
  - Data management (silos or APIs? Formats?)
  - Inhouse AI competency and current efforts
- Picture a realistic framework (organisational and practical) for AI adoption and productive use in the next 2-3 years

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What should Eionet be able to compare and prioritise consistently?

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AI Applications and Value Creation

Prioritise concrete problems and expected value — not particular tools or technologies

04 Potential outcomes & actions

- established organisational policies that enable productive but safe use of AI
- Inhouse exchange regarding needs, efforts and solutions
- Identify 2-3 prime use cases (end-to-end) that could act as a best practice example
- Collect lessons learned, engage in active exchange between EIONET and inhouse AI practitioneers and stake holders

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Which common template or framework would save members time?

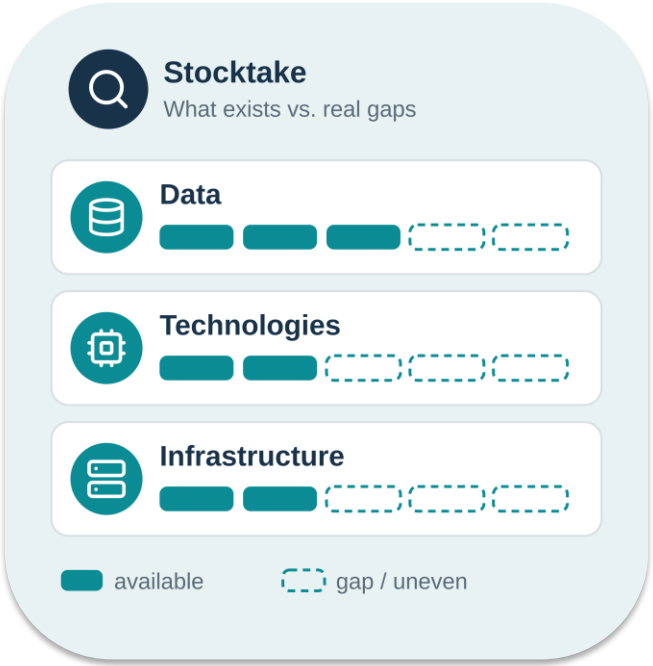
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Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

Create the enabling conditions for useful, responsible and reusable AI applications

01 Where are we

- **Data –** Rich environmental data already exist (Eionet reporting, INSPIRE, Copernicus), but quality, documentation, licensing and AI-readiness vary widely. Controversial cases of data usage for model learning.
- **Technologies –** Tools and models are adopted project by project; the link between use-case needs and what technologies can realistically deliver is often unclear. US models closed, Chinese are more open.
- **Infrastructure –** Compute, platforms and deployment capacity are uneven on global, EU level; national and European assets are hard to discover, compare and reuse.

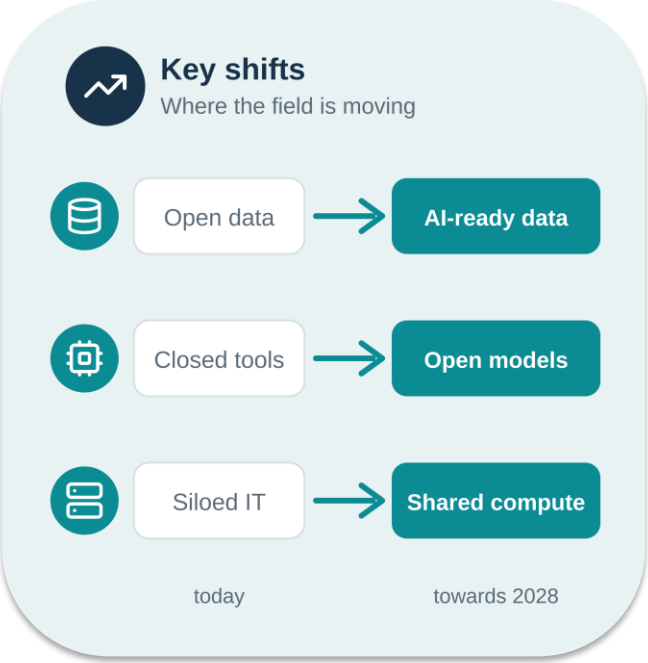


Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

Create the enabling conditions for useful, responsible and reusable AI applications

02 Trends

- **Data –** The focus shifts from open data to AI-ready data: richer metadata, semantics and governance, with European data spaces setting common rules.
- **Technologies –** Open and local models, Earth-observation foundation models and agentic tools on open protocols gain ground, reducing vendor lock-in.
- **Infrastructure –** Shared cloud and HPC capacity grows (e.g. EuroHPC AI Factories, DestinE); security, sovereignty, lifecycle and energy use become core concerns.



Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

Create the enabling conditions for useful, responsible and reusable AI applications

03 Proposed targets to be achieved

- **Data –** TG can assess and improve the AI-readiness of their priority environmental datasets using a common, lightweight set of criteria.
- **Technologies –** A shared view of proven technologies, standards and reusable components, mapped to priority use cases, so solutions are not reinvented.
- **Infrastructure –** A clear picture of available national and European cloud, HPC and platform capacity, the main gaps, and realistic routes for members to access it.



Data, Technologies and Infrastructure

Create the enabling conditions for useful, responsible and reusable AI applications

04 Potential outcomes & actions

- **Data –** AI Data Readiness & Governance Framework: criteria, a simple self-assessment template and relevant examples for data assets.
- **Technologies –** Technology Reference Overview: curated architectures, standards, models and reusable components, each linked to use cases where it works.
- **Infrastructure –** Infrastructure Access Guide: national and European compute and platform options with access routes, conditions and members' lessons learned.

